

MONTESORI HOME ACTIVITIES GUIDE

100 Activities by Age Using Household Items

By Daniel Tesfamariam

MONTESSORI PRINCIPLES FOR HOME

- Follow the child - observe their interests
- Prepare the environment - child-sized, accessible
- Freedom within limits - choices, not chaos
- Hands-on learning - concrete before abstract
- Independence - 'Help me do it myself'
- Real work - practical life skills are learning

AGES 0-12 MONTHS: SENSORY EXPLORATION

1. Treasure basket with safe household objects (wooden spoon, fabric, brush)
2. Black and white contrast cards (newborn to 3 months)
3. Tracking a slow-moving object with eyes
4. Tummy time with a mirror
5. Grasping rattles and fabric squares
6. Exploring different textures (smooth, rough, soft, bumpy)
7. Listening to different sounds (bells, crinkle paper, music)
8. Pulling tissues from a box (great motor practice!)
9. Stacking and knocking down soft blocks
10. Water play in shallow container with supervision

AGES 1-2 YEARS: PRACTICAL LIFE

1. Transferring beans between bowls with spoon
2. Pouring water between small pitchers
3. Opening and closing containers (jars, boxes)
4. Putting balls into a container and dumping
5. Simple puzzles (knob puzzles, 2-3 pieces)
6. Wiping table with small sponge
7. Matching socks from laundry
8. Peeling a banana or orange
9. Sweeping with child-sized broom
10. Putting shoes in shoe rack
11. Watering a plant with small watering can
12. Sorting objects by color into bowls
13. Threading large beads on thick string
14. Washing vegetables in water
15. Carrying breakable items carefully (builds focus)

AGES 2-3 YEARS: INDEPENDENCE SKILLS

1. Dressing self (elastic pants, velcro shoes)
2. Pouring own water from small pitcher
3. Spreading butter/cream cheese on bread
4. Cutting soft food with butter knife
5. Washing hands independently (step stool at sink)
6. Folding small washcloths
7. Setting table (placemat with outlines)
8. Caring for a pet (filling water bowl)
9. Sorting silverware from dishwasher
10. Planting seeds in soil
11. Cutting with scissors (playdough or paper strips)
12. Lacing cards or threading pasta
13. Matching shapes and colors
14. Building with blocks (copying simple patterns)
15. Washing dishes in soapy water

AGES 3-4 YEARS: CONCENTRATION & ORDER

1. Pouring from pitcher to multiple cups (tea party)
2. Buttoning and zipping jackets
3. Cutting food for snack with supervision
4. Sweeping floor with dustpan
5. Polishing shoes or silver items
6. Sewing with large blunt needle on burlap
7. Washing windows with spray bottle and cloth
8. Arranging flowers in a vase
9. Making simple recipes (no-bake cookies, salad)
10. Sorting objects by multiple attributes (size AND color)
11. Building complex block towers
12. Tracing shapes and letters in sand/salt tray
13. Caring for plants (watering, removing dead leaves)
14. Folding own laundry
15. Making bed independently

AGES 4-6 YEARS: ACADEMIC READINESS

1. Sandpaper letters - tracing with fingers
2. Moveable alphabet - building words
3. Counting with real objects (beans, buttons)
4. Addition with physical items
5. Reading simple 3-letter words
6. Writing in a journal (drawing + labeling)
7. Geography - continent puzzle map
8. Science experiments (sink/float, magnet testing)
9. Cooking with measuring cups (math in action)
10. Creating a nature journal
11. Time telling with analog clock
12. Money recognition and counting coins
13. Simple chapter books (read aloud together)
14. Board games requiring strategy
15. Writing letters to family members

SETTING UP YOUR MONTESSORI HOME

Kitchen:

- Low shelf with child's dishes and cups
- Step stool at counter
- Water pitcher they can reach
- Healthy snacks at their level

Bedroom:

- Floor bed or low bed (independence)
- Clothes in low drawers they can reach
- Mirror at their height
- Limited toys, rotated weekly

Bathroom:

- Step stool at sink and toilet
- Towel hook at child height
- Toothbrush and soap accessible

Living areas:

- Low bookshelves (books face out)
- Art supplies accessible
- Child-sized table and chair
- Nature table for seasonal collections

By Daniel Tesfamariam | The child who can do for themselves, will.